UNIT 23.1 · LEVEL B1

Reported speech – say vs tell

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 She _____ me that she was hungry.

a) said **b)** spoke **c)** told **d)** talked

2 He _____ that he would call later.

a) said **b)** told **c)** asked **d)** spoke

3 My teacher _____ us an interesting story.

a) spoke **b)** said **c)** talked **d)** told

4 Tom said _____ he liked the new job.

a) me **b)** that **c)** us **d)** to

5 Anna _____ her mother the truth.

a) said **b)** told **c)** spoke **d)** replied

6 Mark _____ to me that he was busy.

a) told **b)** asked **c)** spoke **d)** said

7 Please _____ me what time the bus leaves.

a) tell **b)** say **c)** speak **d)** talk

8 Her brother _____ a lie, and everyone knew it.

a) said **b)** talked **c)** told **d)** spoke

9 The doctor _____ that I should drink more water.

a) told **b)** asked **c)** spoke **d)** said

10 Lisa _____ everyone she was moving to Canada.

a) told **b)** said **c)** spoke **d)** added

Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 My boss _____ me that the report was ready.

12 Paul _____ that he was learning Spanish.

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13 The guide _____ us some interesting stories about the castle.

14 She _____ to her friend that she felt nervous.

15 He always _____ the truth, even when it is hard.

16 Nobody _____ anything at the meeting.

17 Could you _____ me the way to the station?

18 Ben _____ his parents that he had a new job.

19 What did the teacher _____ about the homework?

20 I _____ them I couldn't come, so they started without me.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **She / told / me / that / she / was / late.**

_____

22 **He / said / that / he / was / hungry.**

_____

23 **My / teacher / told / us / an / interesting / story.**

_____

24 **Tom / said / to / me / that / he / was / busy.**

_____

25 **Please / tell / me / the / truth.**

_____

26 **Anna / told / her / friends / that / she / was / moving.**

_____

27 **The / doctor / said / that / I / was / healthy.**

_____

28 **Don't / tell / anyone / my / secret.**

_____

Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the correct verb.*
Our neighbor _____ me that the party was on Friday.
Options: **said** / **told** / **spoke**

30 *Choose the correct verb.*
My sister _____ that she was tired.
Options: **told** / **said** / **talked**

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31 *Choose the correct verb.*
Grandpa loves to _____ jokes at dinner.
Options: **say** / **speak** / **tell**

32 *Choose the correct verb.*
Can you _____ goodbye to everyone for me?
Options: **tell** / **say** / **speak**

33 *Choose the correct verb.*
She _____ that she didn't know the answer.
Options: **told** / **said** / **asked**

34 *Choose the correct verb.*
He _____ his friends the good news.
Options: **said** / **spoke** / **told**

35 *Choose the correct verb.*
Did he _____ anything about the exam?
Options: **say** / **tell** / **speak**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each direct statement with the correct reported sentence.

1. Tom to Ana: "I'm late." _____
2. Mia: "I like tea." _____
3. Ben to us: "I'm hungry." _____
4. Sue: "I'm busy." _____

A. Mia said that she liked tea.
B. Sue said that she was busy.
C. Tom told Ana that he was late.
D. Ben told us that he was hungry.

37 Match each expression to its meaning.

1. tell the truth _____
2. tell a joke _____
3. say hello _____
4. tell the time _____
5. say sorry _____

A. apologize
B. greet someone
C. be honest
D. make people laugh
E. read a clock

38 Match each wrong sentence to its correction.

1. She said me a secret. _____
2. He told hello to everyone. _____
3. I told that I was happy. _____
4. They said us the truth. _____
5. We said a story to the kids. _____

A. He said hello to everyone.
B. They told us the truth.
C. We told the kids a story.
D. She told me a secret.
E. I said that I was happy.

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39 Match each beginning with the best ending.

1. The weather report said _____
2. My grandmother told us _____
3. The sign on the door said _____
4. The pilot told the passengers _____

A. a story about her childhood
B. that the shop was closed
C. that the plane would land soon
D. that it would rain all weekend

40 Match each phrase to its meaning.

1. say yes _____
2. say no _____
3. tell a secret _____
4. tell a story _____
5. say a few words _____

A. narrate events
B. give a short speech
C. refuse
D. share private information
E. agree

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 She said me that she was late. Correct word: _____

42 He told that he was sick. Correct word: _____

43 They told to us that they were happy. Correct word: _____

44 My uncle says a lot of funny stories. Correct word: _____

45 I said him that I was busy. Correct word: _____

46 He said the truth about the accident. Correct word: _____

47 Can you say me your phone number? Correct word: _____

48 Say goodbye to your sister for me. Correct word: _____

49 The manager said the staff that the office was closed.
Correct word: _____

50 Mia told 'good morning' to everyone. Correct word: _____

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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Answer Key

Reported speech – say vs tell

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** told	Tell needs a person: told me.
2	**a)** said	Say can be followed directly by that.
3	**d)** told	We tell a story to someone.
4	**b)** that	Say + that-clause.
5	**b)** told	Tell the truth is a fixed phrase.
6	**d)** said	Say + to + person.
7	**a)** tell	Tell + person + information.
8	**c)** told	Tell a lie is a fixed phrase.
9	**d)** said	No person after the verb: said.
10	**a)** told	Tell + person + clause.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**told**	Tell is followed by a person.
12	**said**	No person here, so use said.
13	**told**	Tell + person + story.
14	**said**	Say + to + person.
15	**tells**	Tell the truth: present simple tells.
16	**said**	Say is used without a person.
17	**tell**	Tell me + information.
18	**told**	Tell + person + that-clause.
19	**say**	Say is used with what, no person.
20	**told**	Tell + person: told them.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**She told me that she was late.**	Told + person + that-clause.
22	**He said that he was hungry.**	Said + that-clause.
23	**My teacher told us an interesting story.**	Told + person + object.
24	**Tom said to me that he was busy.**	Said + to + person.
25	**Please tell me the truth.**	Tell + person + object.
26	**Anna told her friends that she was moving.**	Told + person + that-clause.
27	**The doctor said that I was healthy.**	Said without a person.

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28	**Don't tell anyone my secret.**	Tell + person + secret.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**told**	A person follows: told me.
30	**said**	No person after the verb.
31	**tell**	We tell jokes.
32	**say**	Goodbye uses say.
33	**said**	No person follows.
34	**told**	Tell + person + news.
35	**say**	Say anything, with no person.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	Tom to Ana: "I'm late." – Tom told Ana that he was late.; Mia: "I like tea." – Mia said that she liked tea.; Ben to us: "I'm hungry." – Ben told us that he was hungry.; Sue: "I'm busy." – Sue said that she was busy. Tell needs a person; say does not.
37	**1-C 2-D 3-B 4-E 5-A**	tell the truth – be honest; tell a joke – make people laugh; say hello – greet someone; tell the time – read a clock; say sorry – apologize Learn the fixed phrases.
38	**1-D 2-A 3-E 4-B 5-C**	She said me a secret. – She told me a secret.; He told hello to everyone. – He said hello to everyone.; I told that I was happy. – I said that I was happy.; They said us the truth. – They told us the truth.; We said a story to the kids. – We told the kids a story. Tell takes a person; say does not.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	The weather report said – that it would rain all weekend; My grandmother told us – a story about her childhood; The sign on the door said – that the shop was closed; The pilot told the passengers – that the plane would land soon Think about who speaks and who listens.
40	**1-E 2-C 3-D 4-A 5-B**	say yes – agree; say no – refuse; tell a secret – share private information; tell a story – narrate events; say a few words – give a short speech Say and tell make different phrases.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**told** (or: said to)	Say does not take a direct person.
42	**said** (or: told me, told us, told her, told them)	Without a person, use said.
43	**told us** (or: said to us)	Tell takes a person directly.
44	**tells**	We tell stories.
45	**told** (or: said to)	Use told + person.
46	**told**	Tell the truth is a fixed phrase.
47	**tell**	Use tell + person.
48	**Say**	Goodbye uses say.
49	**told** (or: said to)	Use told + person.
50	**said**	Greetings use say.

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